shower of arrows the elephants panicked, turned around, and ran away. In the confusion, the Mongol cavalry remounted their horses and charged after the Burmese.

Led by Prince Sangudar, the Mongols again invaded Burma in 1283. The Mongols attacked the border fortresses at Htigyaing and Tagaung near Bhamo and quickly defeated the Burmese army, opening the Ayeyarwaddy River valley to invasion. Frightened by the prospect of being taken captive by the Mongols, Narathihapati fled southward to Bassein and offered submission to the Mongol Empire, thus earning the nickname Tarokpyemin (the king who ran away from the Chinese). Having lost the respect of his people following his cowardly retreat following the battle of Bhamo, Narathihapati was assassinated by his second son Thihathu as he tried to return to Bagan. Thihathu then fought his two brothers who were rivals to the throne. Taking advantage of the political turmoil created following the assassination of Narathihapati, Kublai Khan's grandson Temür led a large Mongol army down the Ayeyarwaddy River valley, captured Bagan, and deposed Thihathu. After taking Bagan the Mongols went on to sack the city, destroying thousands of pagodas, temples, and stupas. In the aftermath of the sacking of Bagan the Tai Shan briefly gained control over the Ayeyarwaddy valley, the Shan plateau, Laos, Thailand, and Assam, only to be forced from northern Burma the following decade when the Mongols installed Narathihapati's son Kyawswa (r. ca. 1287–1298), who then submitted to Mongol vassalage. The Mongols incorporated northern Burma into their empire as the province of Chêng-mien but internal power struggles weakened Bagan as various court factions jockeyed for power.

Responding to a request from Prince Tribhuvanaditya, Temür dispatched a detachment of the Mongol army to Burma in 1297. The Mongols were able to successfully expel the Shans from northern Burma. In 1299, the Shans again invaded Bagan and killed Prince Tribhuvanaditya, the last member of the Burmese royal family. The following year Temür launched a punitive raid into Burma in reprisal for the assassination of Prince Tribhuvanaditya. The expedition ended when a Mongol commander accepted a bribe from the Shans and returned to China. After that, the Mongols lost interest in Burma, never to return. Burma then entered a phase of political disintegration and cultural decay for the next three centuries until the emergence of the Toungoo dynasty.